

HORSESHOE BATS

Species of the family Rhinolophidae are distributed throughout southern Europe, Africa, Asia, and Australasia. Their noseleaf is characteristically horseshoe-shaped. They have the most sophisticated echolocation of all bats, involving highly specialized sound transmission and reception.



4–6.5 cm
1½–2½ in

MEHELY'S HORSESHOE BAT *Rhinolophus mehelyi*

A cave-dwelling, medium-sized rhinolophid, this bat is patchily distributed across S. and E. Europe, and the Middle East.



LESSER HORSESHOE BAT *Rhinolophus hipposideros*

Found across Europe, N. Africa, and W. Asia, the lesser horseshoe bat is one of the smallest bats in the world.

3.5–4.5 cm
1½–1¾ in

relatively short,
broad wings

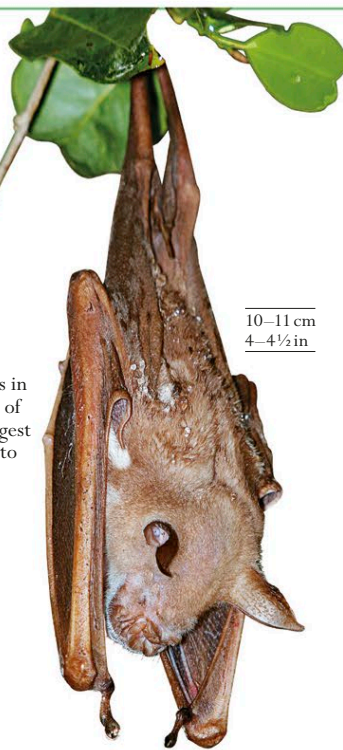
5.5–7 cm
2¼–2¾ in

GREATER HORSESHOE BAT *Rhinolophus ferrumequinum*

The largest of the European horseshoe bats, this species' range extends from Europe eastwards across Asia to Japan.

LEAF-NOSED BATS

Found throughout much of Africa, Asia, and Australasia, the Hipposideridae contains the Old World leaf-nosed bats. They have complex noseleaves and, as with horseshoe bats, their hind legs are poorly developed, making them unable to move quadrupedally.



10–11 cm
4–4½ in

COMMERSON'S LEAF-NOSED BAT *Hipposideros commersoni*

This forest-dwelling bat roosts in hollow trees across the island of Madagascar. It is one of the largest leaf-nosed bats, weighing up to 180 g (6¼ oz).

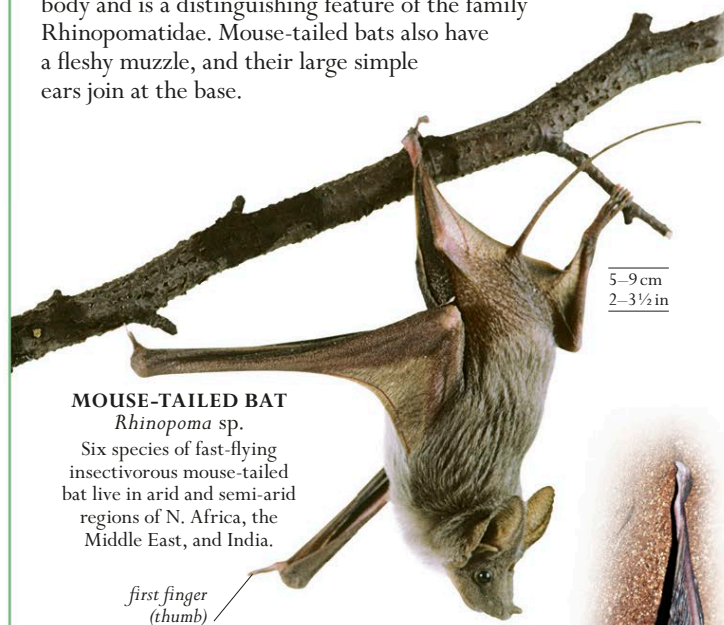
SUNDEVALL'S LEAF-NOSED BAT *Hipposideros caffer*

A savanna species, this leaf-nosed bat roosts in caves and buildings throughout Africa except in the Sahara and central forested regions.

4–6 cm
1½–2¼ in

MOUSE-TAILED BATS

The tail of these bats is nearly as long as their body and is a distinguishing feature of the family Rhinopomatidae. Mouse-tailed bats also have a fleshy muzzle, and their large simple ears join at the base.



5–9 cm
2–3½ in

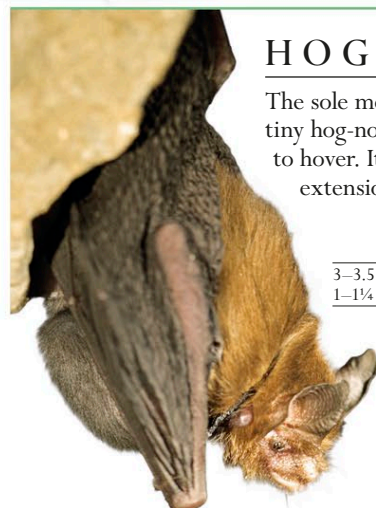
MOUSE-TAILED BAT *Rhinopoma* sp.

Six species of fast-flying insectivorous mouse-tailed bat live in arid and semi-arid regions of N. Africa, the Middle East, and India.

first finger
(thumb)

HOG-NOSED BAT

The sole member of the family Craseonycteridae, the tiny hog-nosed bat has long broad wings that allow it to hover. It lacks a tail and calcars (cartilaginous extensions of the ankle).



3–3.5 cm
1–1¼ in

KITT'S HOG-NOSED BAT *Craseonycteris thonglongyai*

One of the world's smallest mammals, and often called the bumblebee bat, Kitt's hog-nosed bat lives in riverside caves in Thailand and Myanmar.

MEGADERMATIDAE

The family Megadermatidae comprises six fairly large echolocating bat species. Carnivorous and insectivorous, they have large ears and eyes and a broad tail membrane but little or no tail.

10–13 cm
4–5 in

GHOST BAT *Macroderma gigas*

Endemic to N. Australia, the ghost bat is one of the largest microbats. It preys on vertebrates, such as frogs and lizards.

